

A

Ages and stages in the UK



Age	Stage
0	birth [the moment a baby is born]
Up to 12 months	a baby
12 months – 3 years old	a toddler
3–12 years old	a child: this period is your childhood
13–18 approximately	a teenager : during this period you are in your teens
18+	an adult
40+ approximately	people are middle-aged [in the middle of their lives]
60 or 65	retirement [when people stop work; they are retired]
80+	old age (we usually describe people as elderly)

B

Approximate ages

I'm **in my early twenties** [21–23].

My parents are **in their mid-fifties** [54–56].

My grandmother is **in her late seventies** [77–79].

My grandfather is **nearly/almost eighty** [he's probably 79].

My English teacher's **approximately/roughly** thirty.

[about 30 / more or less 30]

Common mistakes

We can say, **he's 30** or **he's 30 years old**. (NOT he has 30 or he's 30 years)

Also: a **30-year-old man**
(NOT a 30-years-old man)

C

Past and present

PAST AND PRESENT

My grandmother's name was Mary. She's **dead**¹ now. She died about ten years ago when I was in my teens, but I remember her well. She was **brought up**² on a farm in Wales, and her parents were very **strict**: as a teenager, they didn't **allow**³ her to listen to the radio or go to parties in the village. **In the end**⁴, she decided to leave home and get a job in Cardiff. **At first**⁵ it wasn't easy, but she **managed**⁶ to find work, and she also met the man who became her husband: my grandfather. My mother was born four years later. She had a very different childhood. She grew up in the city, she **was allowed to** go to parties, and when she was in her teens, her parents **let**⁷ her **stay out late**⁸. My mum is the same with me.



¹ not living; *opp* **alive**

² looked after until you are an adult

³ give permission

⁴ finally, after a lot of time or thought

⁵ at the beginning

⁶ was able (but it was difficult)

⁷ allowed

⁸ not go home until late

Language help

Let and **allow** have the same meaning. **Let** is slightly more informal, and **allow** is often used in the passive.

My dad **let me drive** his car. I **was allowed to drive** my dad's car.

You're not allowed to smoke in that room. (NOT ~~It's not allowed to~~ smoke in that room.)